

MODERN ENGLISH

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

(Prescribed Texts)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for only reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **five** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Section A, you are required to write only **ONE** option as the correct answer.
7. Internal choice has been given in the long answer questions on Drama, Prose and Poetry.
8. Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions in Section B.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

Kindly read aloud the Instructions given above to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

SECTION A – 20 MARKS

Question 1

Choose the correct options for the following questions.

- (i) Where is Act IV of the play, *Pygmalion*, set? (*Recall*) [1]
- (a) Mrs Higgins' drawing room in Chelsea
 - (b) The laboratory at Wimpole Street, at midnight
 - (c) The ambassador's house
 - (d) The portico of St Paul's church, Covent Garden
- (ii) When Higgins suggests in Act IV of the play, *Pygmalion*, that Eliza might marry, why does she reject the idea? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) She regards such a marriage as a way of selling herself.
 - (b) She is already engaged to Freddy.
 - (c) She hopes to marry Colonel Pickering.
 - (d) She believes she is too young to marry.

- (iii) Read the two statements from the play, *Pygmalion*, and choose the correct option from the ones given below. [1]
Statement I: In Act V, Eliza tells Higgins that Freddy loves her and that she may marry him.
Statement II: In Act V, Doolittle has been left an income by an American millionaire.
(Understand)
 (a) Statements I and II are similar.
 (b) Statement I and II are unrelated to each other.
 (c) Statement I is the result of Statement II.
 (d) Statement II is the result of Statement I.
- (iv) Shaw subtitles *Pygmalion* “A Romance in Five Acts”. What is ironic about this? *(Analyse)* [1]
 (a) The love story expected between Eliza and Higgins never happens.
 (b) The play is really a tragedy that ends in death.
 (c) Shaw disliked all romances and refused to write one.
 (d) None of the characters ever falls in love.
- (v) In the short story, *The Doll’s House*, who sends the doll’s house to the Burnell children? [1]
(Recall)
 (a) Aunt Beryl
 (b) Old Mrs Hay
 (c) The children’s teacher
 (d) Pat, the handyman
- (vi) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, why do the boys bring Bobby Daniels into their plan? [1]
(Understand)
 (a) He knows about insects.
 (b) He owns a gun.
 (c) He is Charles’s cousin.
 (d) He is the strongest boy in the neighbourhood.
- (vii) At the end of the short story, *Games at Twilight*, why does Ravi weep? *(Understand)* [1]
 (a) He has hurt himself in the shed.
 (b) He realises the others had forgotten him and he did not matter to them.
 (c) Raghu has beaten him in a fight.
 (d) His mother scolds him for staying out so late.
- (viii) In the poem, *Refugee Blues*, what does the speaker at the public meeting say will happen if the refugees are let in? *(Recall)* [1]
 (a) They will spread disease.
 (b) They will steal our daily bread.
 (c) They will start a war.
 (d) They will refuse to learn the language.

- (ix) In the poem, *My Grandmother's House*, what is suggested by the snakes moving among the books? (*Interpret*) [1]
- (a) Decay and neglect where there had once been learning and love
- (b) That her grandmother kept snakes as pets
- (c) That the books were about wild animals
- (d) That the poet was afraid to go into the library
- (x) In the poem, *Urban*, what does the reference to the broken roads suggest? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) The disorder and decay of city life, which leads nowhere
- (b) Damage caused by a recent earthquake
- (c) The man's love of travelling
- (d) The city's fine modern highways

Question 2

Answer any **five** of the following subparts in 40-50 words.

- (i) In Act V of the play, *Pygmalion*, what does Higgins mean when he tells Eliza that he cannot turn her soul on? (*Interpret*) [2]
- (ii) In Act V of the play, *Pygmalion*, why does Doolittle say that he was happier as one of the undeserving poor? (*Understand*) [2]
- (iii) In the short story, *The Doll's House*, why does Kezia invite the Kelveys to see the doll's house? (*Understand*) [2]
- (iv) In the short story, *The Dreamer*, why does Adela Chemping nearly faint in the store? (*Recall*) [2]
- (v) In the poem, *Refugee Blues*, what does the speaker say about the country the refugees once had? (*Understand*) [2]
- (vi) In the poem, *My Grandmother's House*, why does the poet tell the person she calls darling that he cannot believe she once lived in such a house? (*Understand*) [2]

SECTION B – 60 MARKS

PYGMALION: GEORGE BERNARD SHAW

Question 3

- (i) How does Higgins behave at his mother's 'at home' in Act III? What does his behaviour show about him? [5]
- Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Understand*)
- His manners with his mother and her guests
 - What it shows about him
- (ii) What does Shaw's sequel to the play tell us about Eliza's life after the final scene? [5]
- Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Understand*)
- Her marriage and the flower shop
 - Her continuing relationship with Higgins

- (iii) **(a)** How does Shaw use and overturn the myth of Pygmalion in Acts III to V of the play? [10]
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Analyse*)

OR

- (b)** Were Higgins and Pickering right to carry out their experiment on Eliza? Give your opinion with reference to Acts III to V of the play. [10]
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

PERSPECTIVES: A COLLECTION OF SHORT STORIES

Question 4

- (i) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, how is the father-thing different from Charles's real father? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Interpret*)
- How it looks and behaves
 - What is missing in it
- (ii) In the short story, *Games at Twilight*, how does Ravi see Raghu? Why does he want so badly to beat him? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Interpret*)
- Raghu's nature
 - Why Ravi wants to beat him
- (iii) **(a)** Is the narrator of the short story, *Death by Scrabble*, a reliable guide to what happens? [10]
Examine how the first-person point of view shapes the story.
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Analyse*)

OR

- (b)** Bring out the comic element in the short story, *The Dreamer*, and show how Saki satirises the craze for bargains. [10]
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

REFLECTIONS: A COLLECTION OF POEMS

Question 5

- (i) In the poem, *Urban*, what do the distant hills symbolise? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Interpret*)
- No nearness to nature
 - No escape from the city's chaos

- (ii) In the poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*, how is the cut tomato presented as a gift? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.

(Understand)

- The tomato cut open
- Nothing is wasted

- (iii) (a) How does the poem, *My Grandmother's House*, present memory as both a comfort and a source of pain? [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Evaluate)

OR

- (b) What does the poem, *The Black Santa*, suggest about a child's faith and imagination? [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Evaluate)

— — — —